

SEP 119

Thuto ya 2

Greeting terms: Madume

Lesson outcomes:

- On completing this unit, participants should be familiar with the two most frequently used greeting terms in Sepedi.
 - Individual greeting another person, both the person greeting and the one who is greeted
 - Individual greeting a group of people
 - Individual as part of a group greeting a group of people

1st and 2nd person:

I, we, you(singular), & you (plural)

PRONOUN	CONCORD/COPULATIVES	MEANING
Nna (1 st person)	Ke	I
Rena (1 st person plural)	Re	We (Plural)
Wena (2 nd person)	O	You (Singular)
Lena (2 nd person plural)	Le	You (Plural)

Tlotlontšu: Vocabulary (greeting terms)

Sepedi	English
Morena/barena	Mr/sir
Mohumagadi/mohumagatšana	Mrs/miss
Dumela!	Be greeted/ Good day
Bjang?	How?
Gabotse	Good, fine, well
šala	Stay behind
Sepela	Go
Kae?	Where?
Gona	There
Phela	Live
Ee	Yes
Aowa	No

Why do we greet?

- Greeting- is an act of communication in which human beings intentionally make their presence known to each other.

1. We greet to:

- Make everyone to feel acknowledged and accepted
- Show respect
- Establish relationships

2. The way in which one greets is determined by the:

- nature of the speech context, i.e. formal versus informal speech context
- social standing of speakers: are they of the same age group or are there big differences in age or seniority?
- number of participants involved: one person greeting one other person, or one person greeting 2 or more people

A re dumedišaneng!

Let us greet one another!

A re dumedišaneng: The 'kae' form

(An individual is greeting another individual)

Speaker A

- Dumela! (Hello)
- **O** kae! (How are you!) [literally: where are you]
- **Le** (nna) ke gona (I'm also fine)
[Literally: I am also here]
- From the literal meanings provided above, it is clear that the word order in Sepedi is very different from the word order in English and Afrikaans.

Speaker B

- Agee! (Hi!)
- **Ke** gona, (wena) **o** kae? (I'm fine. How are you?) [literally: I am here, where are you?]

A re dumedišaneng: The 'kae' form

(An individual is greeting a group of people)

A lecturer

- Dumela**ng**, baithuti! (Good day, students)
- **Le** kae? (How are you(pl)?)
- Le (nna) ke gona. (I am also fine)

- The suffix **-ng** added to the greeting word indicates that the greeting is addressed to more than one person. It is therefore called a plural marker.

Students

- Agee! (Hi)
- **Re** gona. (Wena) **o** kae? (we are fine. How are you?)

A re dumedišaneng: The 'kae' form

(A group is greeting another group of people)

Group A

Dumelang! (Be greeted, all of you!)

Le kae? (How are you(pl)?)
you(pl)?

Le (rena) **re** gona. (We are also fine)

Group B

Agee! (Hello)

Re gona, (lena) **le** kae? (We are fine, how are

Alternative greeting: (The 'phela bjang' form)

(An individual greeting another individual)

Speaker A

- Dumela, Dikeledi! (Hello)
- **O phela bjang?** (How are you?)
[literally: How do you live?]
- **Le nna ke phela gabotse.** (I am also fine). [literally: I live well]

Speaker B

- Agee, Mahlatse! (Hi)
- **Ke phela gabotse. (Wena) o phela bjang?** (I am fine. How are you?) [literally: live well, how do you live?]

Alternative greeting: The 'phela bjang' form

(An individual greeting a group of people)

A teacher

- Dumela^{ng}, baithuti! (Hello, students)
- **Le phela bjang?** (How are you?)
[literally: how do you live?] (Le- plural)
- **Le nna ke phela gabotse.** (I am also fine) [literally: I live well]

also (look at you)

Students

- Agee, morutiši! (Hi, teacher)
- **Re phela gabotse. (Wena) o phela bjang?** (we are fine. How are you?) [literally: we live well, how do you live?]

Thobela

say that for one or more people

An individual greeting an individual

- **Thobela, Morena!**
(Be greeted Sir!)

Agee **mohumagadi!**
(Be greeted madam!)

- O kae?
(How are you?)

Ke gona, (wena) o kae?
(I am fine, how are you?)

- (Le nna) ke gona
(I am also fine)

With the word 'Thobela', there is no distinction between greeting one person or a group of people

Modes of address

- Ma'am- Mma/Mohumagadi
- Sir – Morena
- Women who know each other: sesi
- Men who know each other: warra
- Ladies and Gentlemen: bomme le botate
- Child: Ngwanaka
- Children: bana
- Addressing your friend: mogwera
- Addressing a teacher: morutiši (a male teacher); morutišigadi (a female teacher)
- Addressing the students: baithuti

A re laelaneng: Saying goodbye!

g

Speaker A

- šala gabotse! (keep well)

vs

Speaker B

- Sepela gabotse! (go well)

one staying behind


An individual

- šala^{ng} gabotse! (keep well, everyone!)

vs

A group

- Sepela gabotse! (go well)

A group

- šala^{ng} gabotse! (keep well, everyone!)

vs

A group

- Sepela^{ng} gabotse! (go well, everyone!)

Go leboga: Saying thank you!

Speaker A

- Ke a leboga (Thank you)

vs

Speaker B

- Go leboga **nna** (it is a pleasure)

An individual

vs

A group

Ke a leboga (Thank you, everyone)

- Go leboga **rena** (Pleasure)

A group

vs

A group

Re a leboga (we thank you)

- Go leboga rena (Pleasure)

Exercise 1: Use the 'kae' form

(an individual greeting one person)

Sara

- Dumela! (Be greeted!)

- O ^{kae} -----?

(How are you?)

- Le nna ^{ke teng} -----

(I am also fine)

- O mang?

(Who are you?)

- Ke nna Sara

(I am Sara)

- Le nna ke thabela go go tseba

(Nice to meet you too)

- ^{Salang} ----- gabotse!

(Stay well!)

Piti

Agee! (Be greeted!)

Ke ^{teng} ----, (wena) o ^{kae} -----?

(I am fine, how are you?)

o kae

Ke nna Piti. Wena o mang?

(I am Piti. Who are you?)

(Ke thabela go go tseba Sara)

(Nice to meet you Sara)

^{Sepela} ----- gabotse!

(Go well!)

Exercise 2: use the 'kae' form

(an individual greeting a group of people)

Mokgadi

- **Dumelang! (Be greeted!)**

- **Le -----?**
(How are you?)

- (Le nna) -----
(I am also fine)

----- gabotse!
(Stay well, everyone!)

A group of people

Agee! (Be greeted!)

Re ----, (wena) o -----?
(We are fine, how are you?)

----- gabotse!
(Go well!)

Exercise 3: Use the 'phela bjang' form (An individual greeting a group of people)

Mokgadi

• Dumelang! (Be greeted!)

• ^{phela}Le ----- bjang?

(How are you(pl)?)

• (Le nna) ^{phela}ke-----gabotse

(I am also fine)

^{Salang}

----- gabotse!

(Stay well, everyone!)

Group of friends

Agee! (Be greeted!)

^{phela}Re ----- gabotse, (wena) o ^{phela}-----bjang?

(We are fine, how are you?)

^{Sepela}

----- gabotse!

(Go well!)

Exercise and student activity

Watch the Youtube video in which various forms of greeting are presented:

<https://youtu.be/7BncS815gNM>

Dipotšišo???

Le sepeleng gabotse!